

CFA® Level I *Exam Map*

Where the marks are, how the exam works, and a 12-week route to exam day.

180

multiple-choice
questions

2 × 135

minutes, two sessions

300+

study hours reported by
passing candidates

43%

pass rate, Aug 2026
(CFA Institute)

Where the marks are

Ethical and Professional Standards		10–15%
Quantitative Methods		11–14%
Financial Statement Analysis		11–14%
Equities		11–14%
Fixed Income		11–14%
Derivatives and Risk Management		6–9%
Economics		6–9%
Alternative Investments		6–9%
Corporate Finance		6–9%
Portfolio Construction		8–12%

 High priority: the five heaviest topics. Weights: CFA Institute 2027 topic outline.

The five gold topics are about 55–70% of the exam. Ethics, Quant, FSA, Equities and Fixed Income decide most results. Master them first, then build the rest around them.

12-WEEK ROUTE

A plan that follows how topics build on each other

About 25 hours a week. Studying 15 hours a week? Stretch the same order over 20 weeks.

Wk 1–2	Quantitative Methods + Economics The toolkit: time value, statistics, rates.
Wk 3–4	Financial Statement Analysis Biggest reading load. Start early.
Wk 5	Corporate Finance Short; builds on FSA.
Wk 6–7	Equities Valuation models and market structure.
Wk 8–9	Fixed Income Pricing, yield, duration. Practise daily.
Wk 10	Derivatives + Alternative Investments Payoffs and how each asset behaves.
Wk 11	Portfolio Construction + Ethics Ethics last, so it is fresh on exam day.
Wk 12	Mock exams + review Two full mocks. Fix the error pattern, not just the question.

Exam-day rules worth knowing

- **About 90 seconds per question.** Flag anything over two minutes and come back.
- **No penalty for wrong answers.** Never leave a question blank.
- **Formulas are not given.** Know them well enough to rebuild them, not just recite them.
- **Mocks under exam timing** in the last two weeks show your real pace.

Want this plan built around your exam date?

Book a free 30-minute diagnostic session. We find your weak topics and map your route to exam day. In person in Abu Dhabi or live online.

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